

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ's)

Below are commonly asked questions about:

- Internship requirements for degrees which include the Diploma of Professional Practice (both Engineering and IT)
- Work experience requirements for degrees that do not include the Diploma but still require a 12 week industry placement.

Note: This FAQ page does not answer academic coursework questions. Enquiries relating to academic matters should be directed to the Subject Coordinator.

▼ SECTION 1: PREPARATION FOR INTERNSHIPS

Q: Do I need to take any subjects before I can do my internship?

A: Before commencing your internship, you will need to have completed and passed either 41035 Engineering Practice Preparation 1 (EPP1) or 31016 Career Management for IT Professionals (CMITP)

41035 EPP1 and 31016 CMITP will teach you the skills necessary to find and apply for professional work.

Undergraduate students

- Students undertaking the Bachelor of Engineering (Hons) single or double degrees, including those with the Diploma of Professional Practice, should enrol in 41035 EPP1 the semester immediately after they complete 48230 Engineering Communication.
- Students undertaking the Bachelor of Science in IT Diploma in IT Professional Practice should enrol in 31016 CMITP in their second year before looking for an internship.

Postgraduate students

- Students undertaking the Master of Professional Engineering should enrol in 41035 EPP1 in their first semester.

Q: When should I undertake my internship(s)?

A: When you should undertake your internship(s) depends on the course you are studying:

Engineering Diploma

Junior Internship: You should aim to complete your first internship before you have accumulated more than 87 credit points. If you exceed 87 credit points of study, and have not been enrolled in 41036 Engineering Professional Experience 1 and 41037 Work Integrated Learning 1, you will receive an official notification from the Faculty advising you to complete your first internship as soon as possible. At this stage, we would encourage you to limit your enrolment to 12 credit points a semester until you have secured a placement.

If you have accumulated more than 120 credit points of study in the Diploma of Professional Engineering Practice and have still not completed your junior internship, you will receive notification from the Faculty that your enrolment in all subjects will be terminated until such time as you have completed your junior internship.

Senior Internship : As per the course requisites, you must have completed 41045 Engineering Practice Preparation 2 and a minimum of 147 credit points of academic study before commencing your senior internship.

BE/ Master/ Double degree

Students are encouraged to complete their internship during a summer session prior to entering your final year.

Information Technology:

Students typically complete one 9-month internship in their third year. The internship, and associated Work Integrated Learning subjects, are equivalent to full-time study across the Autumn and Spring sessions. However, there is flexibility in the program to complete the internships earlier and/or complete more than one shorter internship; see [IT Course Information \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/it-course-information\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/it-course-information).

Q: How do I find a placement?

A: You can apply for positions advertised on [Careerhub \(https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/\)](https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/), other [job boards \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/job-boards?module_item_id=495047\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/job-boards?module_item_id=495047) or initiate the process by approaching employers directly. You learn this information in EPP1 or CMITP.

If you require assistance with your job searching strategies, contact us at feitinternships@uts.edu.au or [call the FEIT Internships team \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts) to book a 1:1 consultation.

More resources are available in the [Resources & Internship Guidelines \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/welcome-to-feit-internship-resources?module_item_id=525739\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/welcome-to-feit-internship-resources?module_item_id=525739) module.

Q: I have significant engineering experience, can I apply for an exemption/RPL?

A: Depending on your case, engineering students may be eligible for exemption from the first/junior internship ie 41036 EPE1 / 41037 WIL1. To enquire about your eligibility for an exemption you can email feitinternships@uts.edu.au either before or while completing 41035 EPP1 to discuss your situation. **Exemptions are not granted for the second/senior internship.**

If you believe you have significant experience, you will need to complete the [application for recognition of prior learning \(https://www.uts.edu.au/sites/default/files/2018-11/sau-application-recognition-of-prior-learning.pdf\)](https://www.uts.edu.au/sites/default/files/2018-11/sau-application-recognition-of-prior-learning.pdf) and submit the application form and the below-supporting documentation at the [Student Centre \(https://www.uts.edu.au/current-students/contacts/uts-student-centre\)](https://www.uts.edu.au/current-students/contacts/uts-student-centre) either before completing 41035 EPP1 or while undertaking 41035 EPP1.

Supporting documentation includes:

1. Resume
2. Supporting letter from the organisation stating the below:
 - Presented on official company letterhead with company address and ABN (Australian company only), or certified with the official 'company chop' for international companies
 - States students full name as per their enrolment
 - States the start and finish date of their work experience
 - States the number of hours the student completed and any absences

- A detailed list of the duties the student performed
- The name and contact details of the supervisor/manager
- Be signed and dated by the supervisor/manager

Q: Why can I not receive an exemption for second engineering Diploma internship?

A: The Diploma course allows students to receive an engineering program with industry experience coupled with work-integrated learning. This is our 'point of differentiation' in the area of practice-based engineering education. Your second internship is not about the work experience alone, it's combined with the Work Integrated learning (WIL2) subject. This subject allows you to reflect on the experience and establish habits for lifelong learning and develop your graduate attributes that are essential for effective professional practice.

Q: I have questions regarding my internship, who should I contact?

A: The FEIT internship team are here to answer questions and address any concern. Before contacting us, please make sure your question does not appear in the FAQs.

You can either:

1. Join a student consultation sessions. Just drop in... No appointment is necessary. Hosted via ZOOM every Tuesday 2-3 pm and Thursday 11 am -12 pm (Enter via your UTS Zoom login with meeting ID: 957 0037 753 (<https://zoom.uts.edu.au/j/95700377533>) (<https://zoom.uts.edu.au/j/95700377533>))
2. Send us an email to feitinternships@uts.edu.au*
3. [Call the FEIT Internships team \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts).

* Note: All email correspondence must be sent from your UTS student email address and should always include your student ID number and mobile number. Failure to use your student email address may result in your email being filtered into the UTS spam folder and not being read.

Q: Am I covered by UTS insurance during my placement?

A: If your position is **paid**, you are covered by your employer's insurance. If you are completing an **unpaid** position for course credit, you will be covered by UTS personal accident and public liability insurance provided the internship has been approved by the university. This means that all required paperwork is submitted and signed off prior to the commencement of your internship; your host organisation will be required to submit a Workplace Health and Safety Declaration form and a Student Vocational Placement Agreement form before we can approve your unpaid internship.

Should your work hours/duration change during the course of your placement, you will need to advise the FEIT Internships team at feitinternships@uts.edu.au (<mailto:feitinternships@uts.edu.au>).

For more information regarding UTS personal accident insurance, please see [Insurance FAQ's \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/insurance-faqs\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/insurance-faqs).

Worksite requirements

Students are responsible for ensuring they meet all worksite safety standards while on an internship this includes maintaining a current white card when carrying out construction work.

Note: For students who are undertaking an internship in China, a [Chinese translation of the Student Vocational Placement Agreement \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/whs-and-vocational-agreement-forms\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/whs-and-vocational-agreement-forms) form can be found in the Information for Employers/ Supervisors module.

Q: What will my host organisation/workplace supervisor be required to do?

A: The Host Organisation will be required to:

- Register and be approved on CareerHub (if not done so already)
- Workplace Health and Safety Checklist must be completed and valid

- If placement is UNPAID, Organisation must complete the Vocational Placement Agreement
- In conjunction with the student, develop a defined program of work prior to the placement commencing.
- Accept details of your internship once you have submitted your Placement Summary Form (they will receive an email titled: "[student name]'s internship details pending your approval")
- Provide you with a supervisor to mentor you for the duration of your internship
- Complete an evaluation form at the end of your placement

More information regarding the requirements of your employer can be found in the [Information for Employers/Supervisors](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/welcome-to-the-supervisor-slash-employer-hub) (<https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/welcome-to-the-supervisor-slash-employer-hub>) module.

▼ SECTION 2: INTERNSHIP REQUIREMENTS

Q: How do I know if a position I have found meets course requirements?

A: The position must fulfil the following criteria:

- The position duties must relate directly to your major(s) (the organisation does not need to be an engineering / IT organisation eg. A software developer position can be found in a bank or insurance company).
- Your workplace supervisor must be a qualified engineer or IT professional.
- The placement must provide you with an opportunity to apply and extend the knowledge and competencies you have gained at university.
- The duties must be of a meaningful nature. Basic repetitive labouring work such as bricklaying, digging, wiring etc. should not be a significant part of your duties.
- Your hours must meet the requirement of your course

Q: How many hours must I work to meet my course requirements?

A: Part-time internships are permitted across both Engineering and IT practice programs. Weekly-required hours for all courses are a minimum of 21 hours and a maximum of 42 hours.

Engineering degrees

There are two cases relating to engineering degrees depending on whether or not you are doing the Diploma in Professional Engineering Practice with your degree:

With the Diploma:

- **2 x 6-month placements totalling at least 1680 hours.** An internship period is nominally 840 hours in duration (24 weeks @ 35 hours per week). It must cover a minimum of 770 hours, however, no more than 910 hours. Your junior/first internship placement should ideally be one continuous period with the same employer, however, both junior and senior students now have the ability to complete either 1 x 6month placement, 2 x 3-month placements or 1 x 3-month placement plus flexi points. Junior internship students need to email feitinternships@uts.edu.au or call the FEIT Internships team to advise how they wish to split their first internship placement. For more information please see the [Flexi Internships \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/what-is-flexible-engineering-internships?module_item_id=477049\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/what-is-flexible-engineering-internships?module_item_id=477049) module.

Without the Diploma:

- **1 x 12-week placement totalling at least 420 hours.** Periods of less than 10 weeks will not be recognised at all. To discuss your situation you will need to email feitinternships@uts.edu.au or [call the FEIT Internships team \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts).

Information Technology degrees

The IT Diploma has the flexibility to allow students to complete one long internship or two shorter internships, a junior and a senior internship.

- **1 x 9-12 month placement totalling at least 1365 hours.**
- **2 x 4.5-month placements totalling at least 1365 hours.**

Q: If I am enrolled in a double degree, must my internship be engineering/IT related?

A: The duties of the position must be engineering/IT work or engineering/IT related work that is relevant to your engineering/IT major of study. The company itself does not need to be an engineering/IT company.

Q: Can I complete my internship at my current job which is in the Engineering and/or IT industry?

A: Yes, provided the duties you perform are related to your major. Refer to 'How do I know if a position I have found meets course requirements?' If you have held the position for more than 12 months you should discuss with your supervisor the possibility of being allocated a new work program/sector/role for your internship period.

Q: Can I undertake my internship in part-time mode?

A: Yes, part-time placements are approved provided you work the minimum 21 hours per week until you have met your required course hours.

Q: Can I work full-time during my placement if I am an international student?

A: Yes, when work experience is a required part of your course, you are allowed to work full-time (over 40 hours a fortnight) provided your Placement Summary Form has been submitted and approved before starting.

Refer to ["See your visa conditions" on the Australian Government Department of Home Affairs Immigration and Citizenship website](http://www.border.gov.au/trav/stud/more/work-conditions-for-student-visa-holders)  (<http://www.border.gov.au/trav/stud/more/work-conditions-for-student-visa-holders>) and [Fair Work Ombudsman - Visa](#)

Holders and Migrants website. ➡ [_ \(https://www.fairwork.gov.au/find-help-for/visa-holders-migrants\)](https://www.fairwork.gov.au/find-help-for/visa-holders-migrants)

Q: Will I receive payment during my internship?

A: Your internship may be either paid or unpaid. This is at the discretion of your host organisation

- Unpaid - UTS financial assistance could be available
- Must meet Australian standard employment rate \$24.95 per hour (\$948.00 per week) or Industry award wage.

Fair Work: [Fair Work Ombudsman - Work Experience and Internships](https://www.fairwork.gov.au/pay/unpaid-work/work-experience-and-internships) ➡ [_ \(https://www.fairwork.gov.au/pay/unpaid-work/work-experience-and-internships\)](https://www.fairwork.gov.au/pay/unpaid-work/work-experience-and-internships)

If you choose to undertake additional unpaid work experience outside of the requirements of the degree , you will not be covered by UTS insurance.

Q: Can I do unpaid work experience additional to the ENGINEERING/ IT Internship subject/s?

A: If you choose to undertake additional unpaid work experience, (for example, you stay on with your host organisation after completion of the required subject hours) you will not be covered by UTS insurance. There are limits on the extent to which UTS can sanction and support unpaid work placements outside course requirements due to the provisions of the Fair Work Act.

Q: Can I undertake my internship overseas / interstate?

A: Overseas and interstate placements are permitted, provided your course requirements are met in full. See 'How do I know if a position I have found meets course requirements?' above.

There are specific requirements for overseas internships. For more information about these requirements see the [International](#)

Internship Guidelines. (<https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/international-internship-guidelines>)

Overseas placements can be found through **CareerHub** (<https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/>), the **UTS GoInGlobal** (<https://www.uts.edu.au/current-students/opportunities/careers/resources/resources-overview/goinglobal>) site or by visiting www.iaeste.org.au  (<http://www.iaeste.org.au>)

Note: Engineering students completing the Diploma in Professional Engineering Practice must complete at least one internship in Australia.

▼ SECTION 3: REGISTERING AND STARTING YOUR INTERNSHIP

Q: I've found an internship and completed the preparation subject, what now?

A: Before starting your internship you must register your internship (see below for instruction steps). If your internship/work experience is not registered in Careerhub prior to your commencement date then as far as we are concerned...it NEVER happened!

Q: How do I register my internship?

A: To register your internship, please follow the steps below:

1. Login to **CareerHub** (<https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/>) (using your UTS username and password).
2. Select dashboard (located along the top bar).
3. Select 'FEIT Placement Workflow' (on the left-hand sidebar).
4. Follow the workflow, reading each step's instructions carefully to lodge your Placement Summary Form

Q: My host organisation is not appearing in CareerHub, what shall I do?

A: Before we can approve your internship placement, the organisation must be registered in CareerHub. If the company hasn't hosted any UTS students for an internship before, you will need to [send them this template. \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/employer-registration-request\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/employer-registration-request)

If they have registered, but they are still not appearing under the 'Select Host Organisation' section of your workflow, it may be because they have selected to be 'hidden' from students. In this case, please contact the FEIT Internship team.

Q: When do I submit my Placement Summary Form?

A: We encourage you to submit your Placement Summary Form as soon as you have secured a placement. Your Placement Summary Form MUST be submitted at least one week before you start your internship.

Q: I've started working and not submitted a Placement Summary Form? Will my work hours count?

A: NO credit for work completed prior to submitting a Placement Summary Form and approved by the facility will not be counted. If you have significant work experience (Master students only) you may be eligible to apply for an RPL - see question 3: I have significant engineering experience, can I apply for an exemption/RPL?

REMEMBER: If we do not approve a Placement Summary Form - the work placement never existed

Q: How do I update or change information on my Placement Summary Form, once it's submitted?

A: Once your form is submitted you can not make changes. Please notify us of any changes by email to the FEIT Internships team (<https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts>). Changes that may be required is your end date or change of supervisor details, etc.

Q: Can I work from home (WFH) during my internship?

A: An internship is not just about learning technical skills but also having exposure to business culture, self-development and office etiquette. The workplace environment is a conducive learning environment. We encourage students to work out of an office environment rather than from home.

As the work environment is changing and more organisation are moving to WFH situations. If this case applies to you. We require that students follow the host organisation's WFH guidelines. The student should also check their work environment and raise any concerns with their supervisor (host supervisor then UTS supervisor if needed).

▼ SECTION 4: INTERNSHIP SUBJECTS AND UNDERTAKING OTHER SUBJECTS WHILE ON AN INTERNSHIP

Q: How do I enrol in the internship subject(s)?

A: There is no self-enrolment option for the following subjects:

- 41028 EWE
- 41036 PE1
- 41037 WIL1
- 41046 PE2
- 41047 WIL2.

Instead, you will be enrolled by FEIT internships after you have submitted the Placement Summary Form and it has been approved by your employer and the faculty.

Q: I have submitted my Placement Summary Form but I'm not yet enrolled in the internship subject(s) - how long will it be until I am enrolled?

A: Once you have submitted your Placement Summary Form, your employer is sent an automatic email with your form to agree to the placement details. After they have approved the email, the faculty will review, approve and enrol you. This will usually take around 48hrs but no more than 7 days. If your subject does not appear on your study timetable, please check the approval status in CareerHub and follow up with either your employer or the [FEIT Internships team \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-contacts) as required.

The Placement Summary Form status code process is:

1. Pending employer approval
2. Pending faculty approval
3. Approved

Q: Can I enrol in extra subjects whilst completing my internship/work experience?

A: There are three different cases depending on which course you are enrolled in and if you are a domestic or international student:

Diploma in Professional Engineering Practice students

- Your internship is equivalent to a full-time study load, therefore, we advise you to withdraw from all subjects while completing your placement. You can enrol in one extra subject if you can confidently handle the workload. Enrolment into more than one extra subject requires academic approval through the submission of an e-request.

International students

- If you are completing work experience while in session (i.e. Autumn or Spring), you will need to submit an [Application to Reduce Study Load \(https://www.uts.edu.au/sites/default/files/2020-06/sau-application-to-reduce-study-load-v7.pdf\)](https://www.uts.edu.au/sites/default/files/2020-06/sau-application-to-reduce-study-load-v7.pdf) in order to meet your student visa requirements. You can enrol in one extra subject if you can confidently handle the workload. More information can be found [here. \(https://www.uts.edu.au/current-students/managing-your-course/classes-and-assessment/academic-progression/international-student-requirements/permission-reduce-study-load\)](https://www.uts.edu.au/current-students/managing-your-course/classes-and-assessment/academic-progression/international-student-requirements/permission-reduce-study-load)

Bachelor of Engineering (Hons) or combined degrees (without the Diploma in Professional Engineering Practice)

- You can enrol in one additional subject if you can confidently handle the workload. Enrolment into more than one extra subject requires academic approval through the submission of an e-request.

Q: Is there a difference between WIL1 and WIL2?

A: Yes. 41037 Work Integrated Learning 1 (WIL1) runs for the entire duration of your internship rather than following the normal UTS semester / session pattern. Submission dates for Assessment Tasks are based on a personalised due date schedule that is calculated from your specific internship start date. Assessment tasks are submitted in Week 8, Week 15 and Week 22 of your internship, regardless of the session in which you are formally enrolled.

41047 Work Integrated Learning 2 (WIL2) is a “session-based” subject so will run for the duration of the semester in which you are enrolled, not for the length of your internship.

Q: I have found an internship after census date, what happens now?

A: You should follow the normal internship approval process by submitting your Placement Summary Form. You will be enrolled in your internship subjects for the following session.

Q: My results are showing as withheld, what should I do?

A: Your results for the Professional Experience subject will be processed once you have completed each of the following steps:

1. Submitted the Student Evaluation Form through the FEIT Placement workflow on CareerHub
2. Ensured your supervisor has submitted the Supervisor Evaluation Form

Your results for the Work Integrated Learning subject will be submitted by the subject coordinator once you have completed your required Assessment Tasks.

▼ SECTION 5: DIFFICULTIES WHILE ON AN INTERNSHIP

Q: I'm experiencing difficulty during my placement, who do I contact?

A: Issues can range in severity from starting your internship to find that your duties are not as described to experiencing bullying, sexual harassment, racial vilification, or any other unacceptable behaviour.

We are always here to support our students, in most cases, issues can be resolved by maintaining a regular and open dialogue between yourself and your supervisor. Please talk to your employer and remind them of the placement requirements set out by the university.

If you're unable to resolve the issue, please contact the Student Engagement Coordinator, Victoria Wells, at feitinternships@uts.edu.au or 9514 8490.

Q: I have lost my job, who do I contact?

A: If you have lost your job you will need to contact the FEIT Internships to discuss your situation; email feitinternships@uts.edu.au or [call the FEIT Internships team \(https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-\)](https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/17442/pages/feit-internships-staff-)

[contacts](#)).

Q: I am injured at work during my placement, who do I contact?

A: Once first aid is administered, you or your supervisor **MUST** immediately inform the Student Engagement Coordinator, Victoria Wells, at feitinternships@uts.edu.au or 9514 8490. Please ensure that you complete all employer and/or UTS forms relating to workplace health and safety.

▼ SECTION 6: COMPLETING YOUR INTERNSHIP

Q: I've finished my required internship/work experience hours, what should I do now?

A: Once you finish your placement hours, you must complete the following steps:

1. Login to [CareerHub](https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/) [\(https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/\)](https://careerhub.uts.edu.au/) (using your UTS username and password)
2. Select dashboard (on the top bar)
3. Select 'FEIT Placement Workflow' (on the left-hand sidebar)
4. Submit the 'Student Placement Evaluation Form'

When you submit your Student Evaluation Form, an email will automatically be sent to your workplace supervisor with a link to the 'Supervisor Evaluation Form' for their completion. Please follow-up with your workplace supervisor to ensure they complete this form as your result for the internship subject will not be processed until it has been lodged.

A completion grade can only be released once your student and supervisor evaluation forms are completed and approved by the faculty.